

# Gemini LinkedIn Scout

AI-Powered Networking Tool — Project Documentation

[gemini-linkedin-scout.vercel.app](https://gemini-linkedin-scout.vercel.app) • [github.com/rishav-dutta](https://github.com/rishav-dutta)

Solo Build

PM · Designer · Developer

0 → 1 Product

TypeScript + React

## 1. Overview

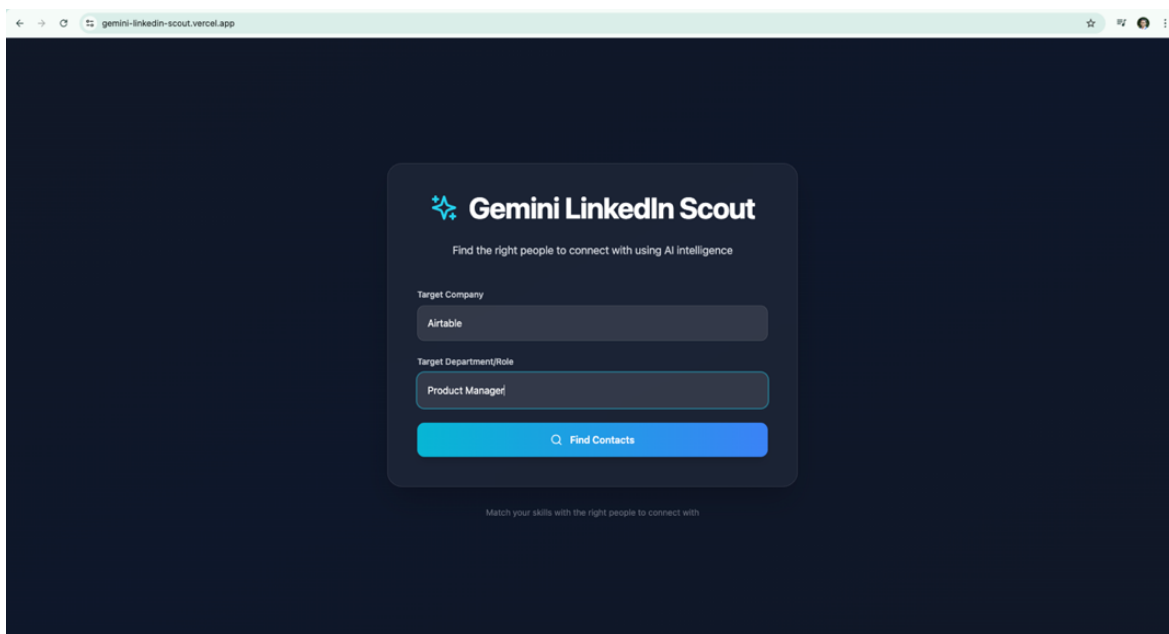
Gemini LinkedIn Scout is an AI-powered networking tool built to eliminate the manual effort of finding the right people to connect with at a target company. Given a company name and a target role or department, the tool automatically discovers relevant LinkedIn profiles, scores them against the user's resume, and surfaces the highest-relevance contacts — ranked with percentage match scores and AI-generated reasoning.

**Core Problem Solved:** Most job seekers waste time manually searching LinkedIn and guessing who to reach out to. LinkedIn Scout automates discovery, relevance scoring, and prioritization in one end-to-end flow.

## 2. Product Flow

### Step 1 — Targeting

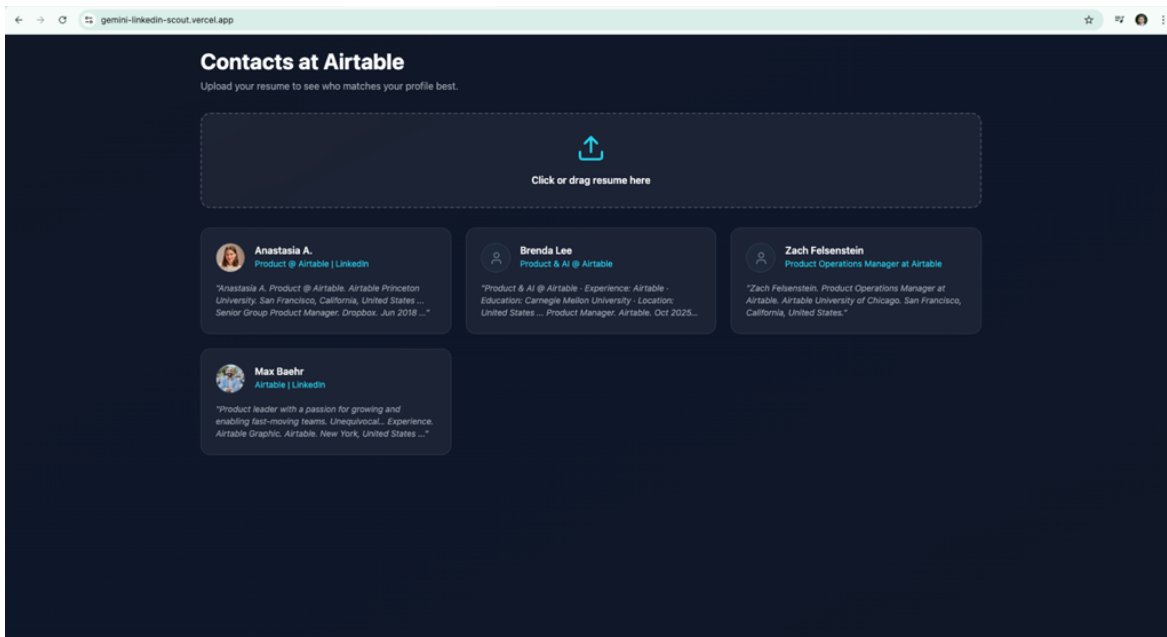
The user enters a Target Company (e.g., “Airtable”) and a Target Department/Role (e.g., “Product Manager”) and clicks “Find Contacts.” The backend kicks off the profile discovery n8n workflow via a webhook call.



The screenshot shows the Gemini LinkedIn Scout web application interface. The header displays the logo and the tagline "Find the right people to connect with using AI intelligence". Below the header, there are two input fields: "Target Company" with the value "Airtable" and "Target Department/Role" with the value "Product Manager". A blue button labeled "Find Contacts" is positioned below the input fields. At the bottom of the form, there is a small text prompt: "Match your skills with the right people to connect with".

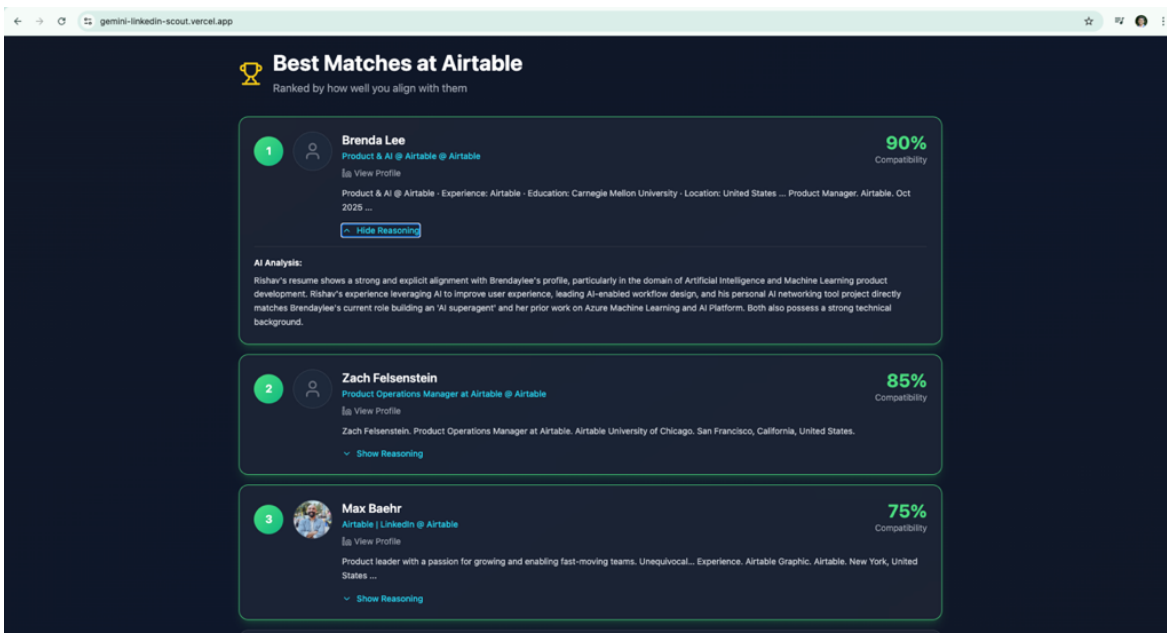
## Step 2 — Resume Upload

The app returns a grid of discovered LinkedIn profiles at that company. The user uploads their resume (PDF) via drag-and-drop to trigger the Gemini-powered relevance scoring engine.



## Step 3 — Ranked Results

The app displays a ranked “Best Matches” list ordered by compatibility score (e.g., 90%, 85%, 75%), with each contact's title, LinkedIn link, profile snippet, and an AI Analysis block explaining why that person is a strong match for the user's background. Framer Motion animations provide smooth transitions between states.



## 3. Tech Stack

| Layer                 | Technology / Details                                     |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Frontend Language     | TypeScript 4+ (93.5% of codebase)                        |
| Frontend Framework    | React 18.3                                               |
| Build Tool            | Vite 5.4                                                 |
| Styling               | Tailwind CSS 3.4                                         |
| Animations            | Framer Motion 12                                         |
| Icons                 | lucide-react 0.344                                       |
| Database Client       | @supabase/supabase-js 2.57 (direct frontend integration) |
| Backend Orchestration | n8n (self-hosted on DigitalOcean)                        |
| AI / LLM              | Google Gemini (via n8n AI Agent node)                    |
| Data Scraping         | Apify — harvestapi/linkedin-profile-scraper actor        |
| Database              | Supabase (PostgreSQL)                                    |
| Server                | DigitalOcean Droplet (Ubuntu 22.04, NYC1, 1 GB RAM)      |
| Deployment            | Vercel (auto-deploy from main, instant rollback)         |
| Analytics             | Vercel Web Analytics                                     |
| Dev Tools             | Claude, Cursor, ESLint, TypeScript compiler              |

## 4. Architecture

The application is a four-layer system: a TypeScript/React frontend on Vercel communicates exclusively through webhook HTTP calls to a self-hosted n8n instance on DigitalOcean. n8n orchestrates all backend logic including scraping, data storage, and AI scoring. Supabase provides the PostgreSQL data layer, and the Supabase JS client is also embedded directly in the frontend for read operations.

**Stack in one line:** React (Vite + TS) → n8n webhooks → Apify scraper + Gemini AI → Supabase PostgreSQL

### 4.1 Frontend — React + TypeScript on Vercel

- TypeScript throughout (93.5% of codebase) with strict tsconfig settings
- Vite 5.4 for fast local dev and optimised production builds
- Tailwind CSS for utility-first styling; Framer Motion for page/card animations
- lucide-react for consistent iconography

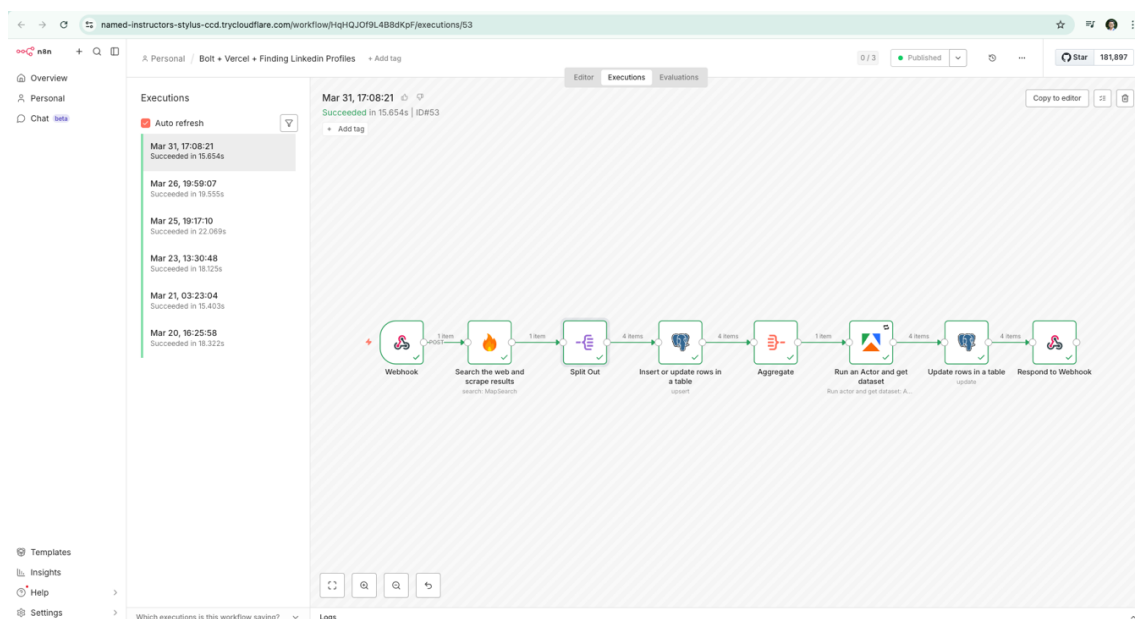
- @supabase/supabase-js client enables the frontend to read ranked results directly from Supabase after n8n writes them
- All backend communication via HTTPS webhook calls to n8n — no custom API server

## 4.2 Backend — n8n Workflows on DigitalOcean

Two production workflows run on a self-hosted DigitalOcean Droplet (1 GB RAM, NYC1, Ubuntu 22.04). Choosing self-hosted over n8n Cloud eliminated per-execution pricing limits and timeout constraints on long Apify scraping jobs.

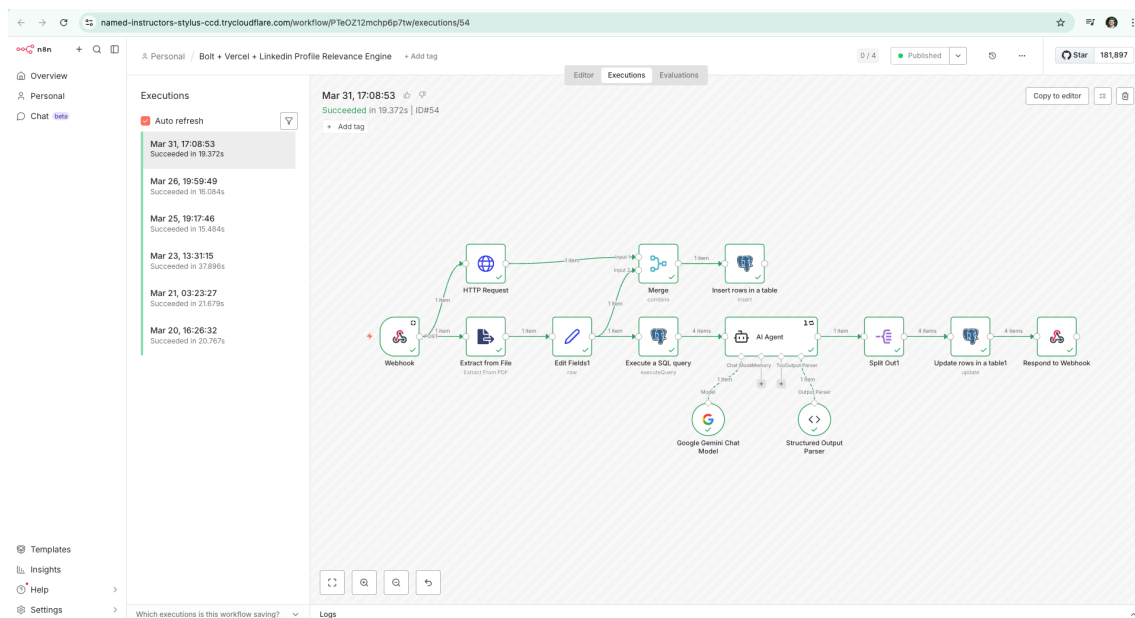
### Workflow 1: LinkedIn Profile Finder

| # | Node                            | Purpose                                                         |
|---|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Webhook                         | Receives company + role payload from the React frontend         |
| 2 | Search the web & scrape results | Searches for LinkedIn profiles matching the company/role query  |
| 3 | Split Chat                      | Parses and splits scraped results into individual records       |
| 4 | Insert / Update rows in table   | Upserts raw profile data into Supabase linkedin_leads table     |
| 5 | Aggregate                       | Consolidates all records before the enrichment step             |
| 6 | Run Apify Actor & get dataset   | Invokes Apify actor for enriched full-profile LinkedIn data     |
| 7 | Update rows in table            | Enriches Supabase rows with full_profile and profile_image data |
| 8 | Respond to Webhook              | Returns the profile list to the React frontend                  |



## Workflow 2: LinkedIn Profile Relevance Engine

| #  | Node                     | Purpose                                                      |
|----|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | Webhook                  | Receives resume upload trigger from frontend                 |
| 2  | HTTP Request             | Fetches stored profiles from Supabase via REST API           |
| 3  | Extract from File        | Parses the uploaded PDF resume into text                     |
| 4  | Edit Fields              | Normalises and flattens resume fields for the AI prompt      |
| 5  | Execute SQL query        | Retrieves target company profiles from Supabase              |
| 6  | Merge                    | Combines resume data with LinkedIn profile records           |
| 7  | Insert rows in table     | Stores the merged scoring input set                          |
| 8  | AI Agent (Gemini)        | Scores each profile vs the resume; generates match reasoning |
| 9  | Structured Output Parser | Extracts JSON {score, reasoning} from the Gemini response    |
| 10 | Split Out                | Separates individual scored profile results                  |
| 11 | Update rows in table     | Writes similarity scores back to linkedin_leads in Supabase  |
| 12 | Respond to Webhook       | Returns ranked results to the React frontend                 |



4.3 Data Layer — Supabase (PostgreSQL)

| Table          | Schema / Purpose                                                                                                                                         |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| linkedin_leads | full_name, job_title, company, linkedin_url, profile_image, search_description, full_profile, similarity_score (INT 0–100), scoring_reasoning, search_id |
| user_resumes   | Stores uploaded resume files (PDF) tied to each search session for the scoring pipeline                                                                  |

| id  | full_name               | job_title                                      | company  | profile_image                                            | linkedin_url                                              | search_description                  | full_profile              | similarity_score |
|-----|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------|----------|----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|---------------------------|------------------|
| 580 | Noemi Salazar Caballero | Senior Product Manager at Hertz   LinkedIn     | Hertz    | https://media.licdn.com/in/noemi-salazar-caballero       | https://www.linkedin.com/in/noemi-salazar-caballero       | Senior Product Manager at Hertz   I | Versatile Product Manager | 75               |
| 581 | Matt Anderson           | Manager Product Operations at Hertz   LinkedIn | Hertz    | NULL                                                     | https://www.linkedin.com/in/matt-anderson-3629927b        | Experience. Hertz. 9 years 10 mont  | No summary pr             | 60               |
| 582 | Daniel Segoviano        | Hertz                                          | Hertz    | https://media.licdn.com/in/daniel-segoviano              | https://www.linkedin.com/in/daniel-segoviano              | Daniel Segoviano. Hertz DePaul Un   | I am a Staff Tec          | 95               |
| 583 | Kareem Joudeh           | Hertz                                          | Hertz    | https://media.licdn.com/in/kareem-joudeh-327aa31a        | https://www.linkedin.com/in/kareem-joudeh-327aa31a        | Kareem Joudeh. Hertz Florida Insti  | Experienced IT            | 90               |
| 584 | Stewart Christensen     | Sr. Product Manager at BambooHR                | BambooHR | https://media.licdn.com/in/stewart5                      | https://www.linkedin.com/in/stewart5                      | Product Manager at BambooHR. Bi     | I'm a Product M           | 90               |
| 585 | Michael Sanders         | Product Management                             | BambooHR | https://media.licdn.com/in/productmanagemichael          | https://www.linkedin.com/in/productmanagemichael          | I joined BambooHR in the very earl  | Fifteen years in          | 65               |
| 586 | Kirstie Leavitt         | Product Manager at BambooHR                    | BambooHR | NULL                                                     | https://www.linkedin.com/in/kirstie-leavitt-b445b4bb      | Kirstie Leavitt. Product Manager at | No summary pr             | 30               |
| 587 | Kimberly Robinson       | Product Manager II at BambooHR                 | BambooHR | https://media.licdn.com/in/kimberly-clarke-robinson      | https://www.linkedin.com/in/kimberly-clarke-robinson      | Kimberly Robinson. Product Mana     | No summary pr             | 40               |
| 588 | Joanna Beltowska        | Product Manager at Google                      | Google   | https://media.licdn.com/in/jbeltowska                    | https://www.linkedin.com/in/jbeltowska                    | Joanna Beltowska. Product Manag     | I'm passionate            | 65               |
| 589 | Diego Granados          | AI Product Manager @ Google                    | Google   | https://media.licdn.com/in/diegogranadosh                | https://www.linkedin.com/in/diegogranadosh                | I'm a Product Manager with experi   | I'm a Product M           | 80               |
| 590 | Kevin Miller            | Product Manager at Google                      | Google   | https://media.licdn.com/in/kamiller2                     | https://www.linkedin.com/in/kamiller2                     | Kevin Miller. Product Manager at G  | I enjoy helping           | 75               |
| 591 | Meridith Blascovich     | Group Product Manager at Google                | Google   | https://media.licdn.com/in/meridithmb                    | https://www.linkedin.com/in/meridithmb                    | Meridith Blascovich. Group Produc   | I adore working           | 70               |
| 592 | Adam Rahman             | Google   LinkedIn                              | Google   | https://media.licdn.com/in/adamrahman                    | https://www.linkedin.com/in/adamrahman                    | Adam Rahman. Google University      | 20+ years of ex           | 15               |
| 593 | Marie-Eve Piche         | Google   LinkedIn                              | Google   | https://media.licdn.com/in/magiche                       | https://www.linkedin.com/in/magiche                       | Marie-Eve Piche. Google Columbia    | No summary pr             | 10               |
| 594 | Jon Silber              | Google   LinkedIn                              | Google   | https://media.licdn.com/in/jonsilber                     | https://www.linkedin.com/in/jonsilber                     | Jon Silber. Google. Los Angeles, C  | Jon is a produc           | 90               |
| 595 | Natalia Zagorodnyaya    | Deal Pricing and Monetization, Google Cloud    | Google   | https://media.licdn.com/in/natalia-zagorodnyaya-26526513 | https://www.linkedin.com/in/natalia-zagorodnyaya-26526513 | Experience - Google Graphic. Prici  | Analytics leader          | 75               |
| 596 | Max Baehr               | Airtable   LinkedIn                            | Airtable | https://media.licdn.com/in/mbaehr                        | https://www.linkedin.com/in/mbaehr                        | Product leader with a passion for g | Product leader            | 75               |
| 597 | Zach Felsenstein        | Product Operations Manager at Airtable         | Airtable | NULL                                                     | https://www.linkedin.com/in/zfcls                         | Zach Felsenstein. Product Operati   | I run Product O           | 85               |
| 598 | Brenda Lee              | Product & AI @ Airtable                        | Airtable | NULL                                                     | https://www.linkedin.com/in/brendaylee                    | Product & AI @ Airtable · Experienc | No summary pr             | 90               |
| 599 | Anastasia A.            | Product @ Airtable   LinkedIn                  | Airtable | https://media.licdn.com/in/anastasia-a-67b1893a          | https://www.linkedin.com/in/anastasia-a-67b1893a          | Anastasia A. Product @ Airtable. Ai | No summary pr             | 60               |

4.4 AI Layer — Google Gemini

- Ingests the user's parsed resume alongside each candidate LinkedIn profile
- Reasons about alignment across domain expertise, skills, role history, and stated interests
- Outputs a structured compatibility score (integer 0–100) + plain-language AI Analysis paragraph per contact
- n8n's Structured Output Parser enforces JSON schema compliance, eliminating parsing failures from LLM preamble

5. Key Product Decisions

Why n8n over a custom API server?

n8n allowed rapid workflow prototyping without writing and maintaining a full backend codebase. Each node is visual and independently debuggable, which dramatically cut development time for a solo build. The execution logs also made debugging the Gemini scoring pipeline significantly faster.

### Why self-hosted n8n on DigitalOcean vs. n8n Cloud?

Full control over the execution environment, no per-execution pricing limits, and the ability to run long-running Apify scraping jobs without hitting cloud timeout constraints.

### Why Supabase?

Instant PostgreSQL with a UI-first table editor, a REST API generated automatically from the schema, and a JS client that works directly from the React frontend — no custom ORM or migration pipeline needed for a solo build. The supabase/migrations folder in the repo tracks schema changes.

### Why score contacts rather than just surface them?

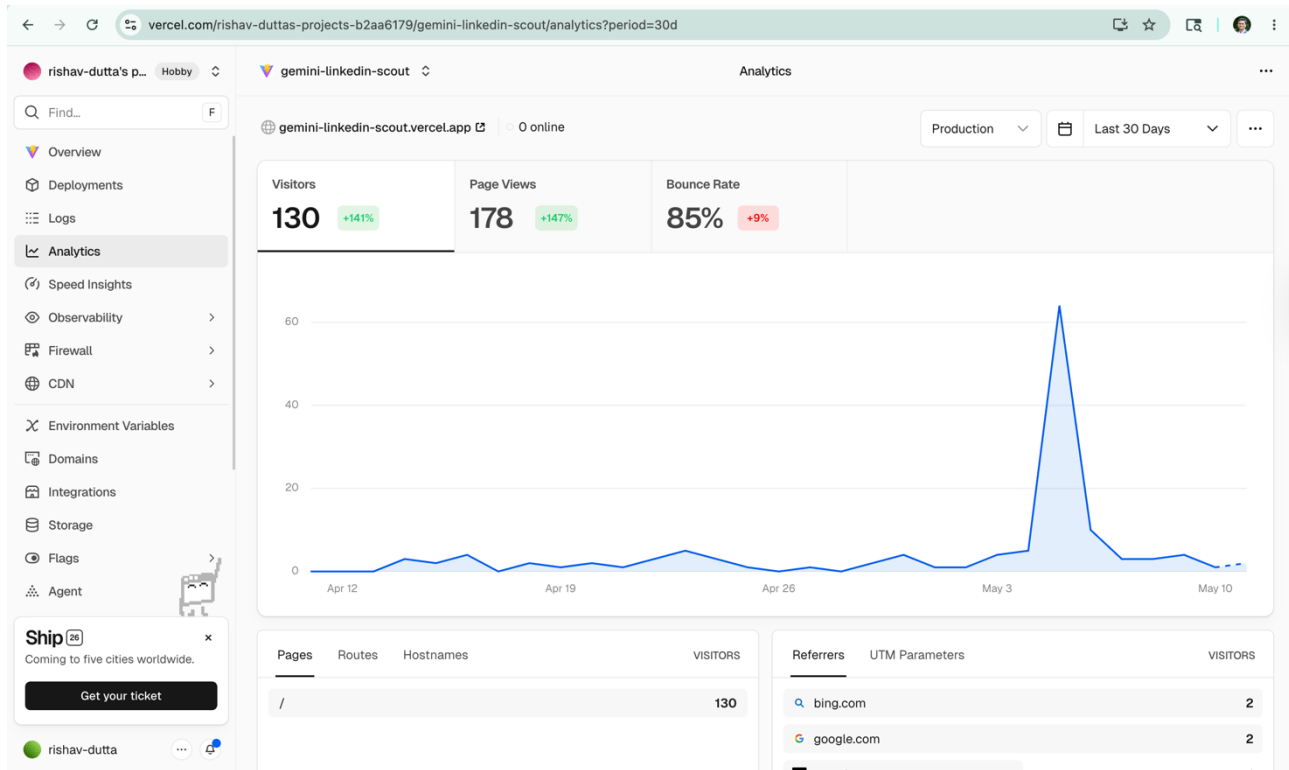
Raw scraping results are noisy. Ranking by resume-to-profile alignment makes the outreach list immediately actionable — the user knows exactly who to prioritise and why, mirroring how a recruiter or hiring manager evaluates fit. This is also the core differentiator of the product.

### Why TypeScript over plain JavaScript?

Type safety on the Supabase query responses and webhook payloads caught several schema mismatches during development. With 93.5% TypeScript coverage across 75 commits, the codebase is significantly more maintainable for future feature additions.

## 6. Metrics & Deployment (Last 30 Days)

| Metric             | Value                                               |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Status             | Live in production                                  |
| Visitors (30d)     | 130 (+141% period-over-period)                      |
| Page Views (30d)   | 177 (+146% period-over-period)                      |
| Bounce Rate        | 85% (+9%)                                           |
| Top Referrers      | bing.com (2), google.com (2)                        |
| Commits            | 75 commits on main                                  |
| Open Pull Requests | 1                                                   |
| Error Rate         | 0%                                                  |
| Deployment model   | Auto-deploy from main via Vercel Git integration    |
| Rollback           | Instant Rollback enabled on Vercel                  |
| Server uptime      | DigitalOcean Droplet — n8n-backend-production, NYC1 |



## 7. Challenges & Learnings

### LinkedIn scraping reliability

Apify actor results vary in completeness depending on profile privacy settings. The workflow handles missing `profile_image` and `full_profile` fields gracefully with NULL defaults and falls back to `search_description` as the scoring input when `full_profile` is unavailable.

### LLM structured output consistency

Gemini responses occasionally included conversational preamble before the JSON payload. Adding n8n's Structured Output Parser node enforced schema compliance and eliminated downstream parsing failures entirely. The fix also improved scoring latency by removing retry logic that had been needed for malformed responses.

### Frontend-backend latency

The full pipeline (scrape → enrich → score) takes 15–30 seconds. Framer Motion loading states on both the profile discovery and relevance scoring phases prevent the experience from feeling broken during processing.

### Solo full-stack scope management

Acting as PM, designer, and developer simultaneously required strict prioritization. The MVP deliberately omitted user authentication and saved-search history to ship a working end-to-end flow first. The 75-commit history reflects iterative, production-focused development rather than big-bang releases.



## 8. Potential Next Features

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- Saved search history per user (requires auth layer — Supabase Auth is already available in the stack)
- Draft InMail / connection request generator based on the matched contact's profile + user's resume
- Batch company search — run the discovery pipeline for multiple companies simultaneously
- Score threshold filter — show only contacts above a minimum compatibility percentage
- Export ranked contact list to CSV for CRM or outreach tool import
- Webhook-based refresh to re-score contacts when the user uploads an updated resume